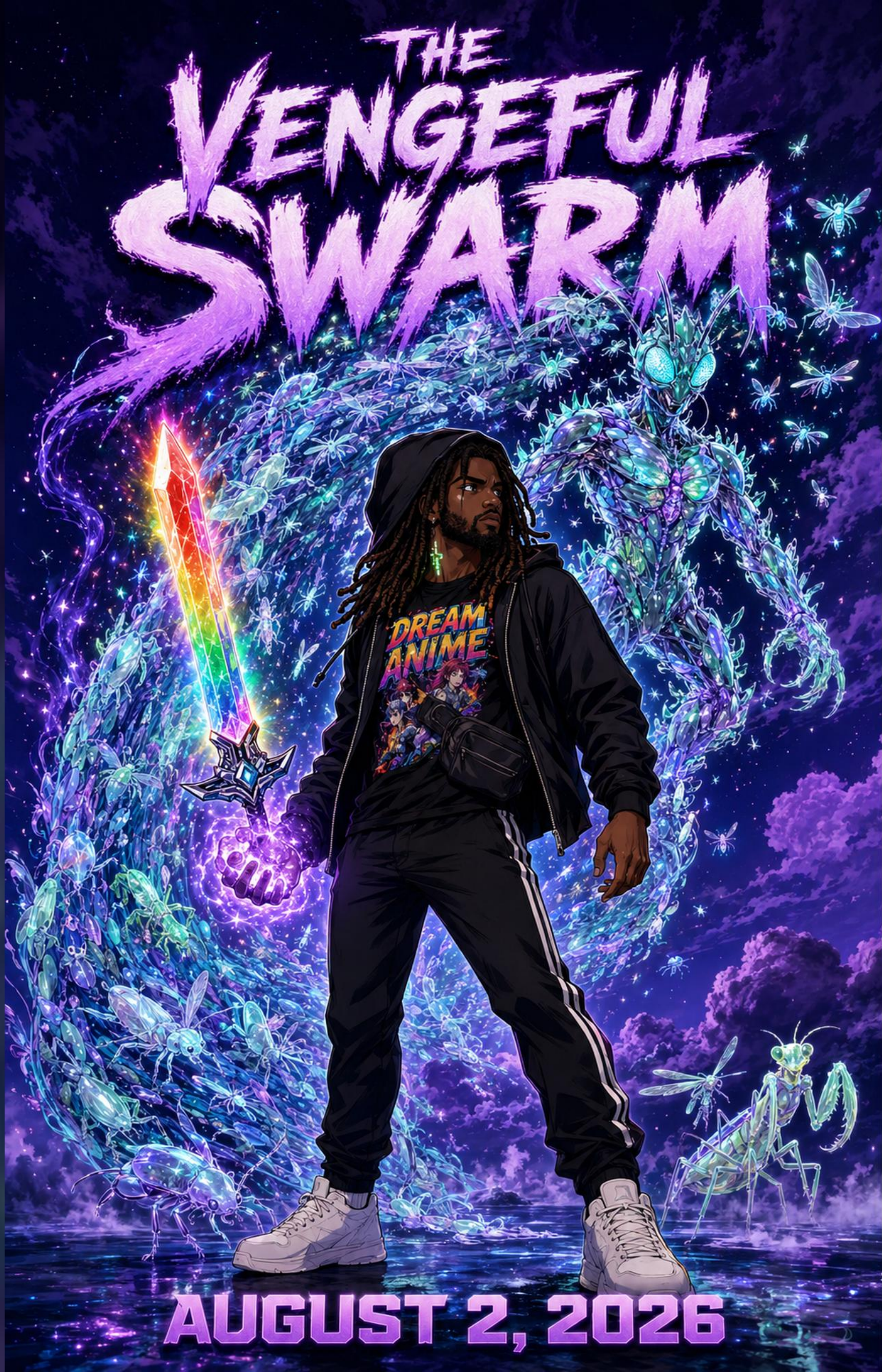
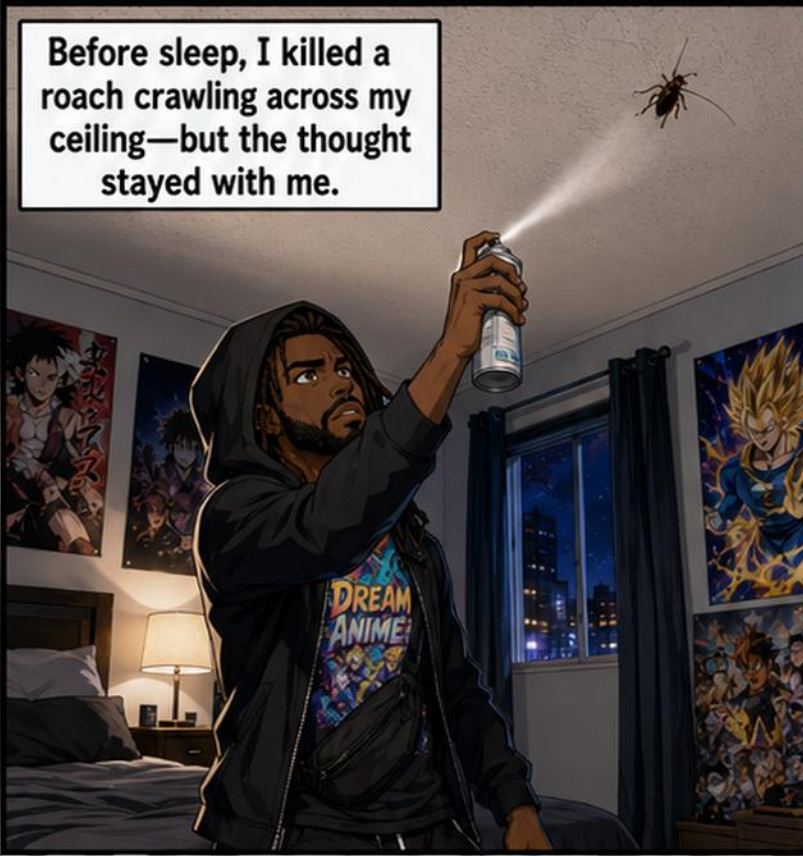


THE VENGEFUL SWARM

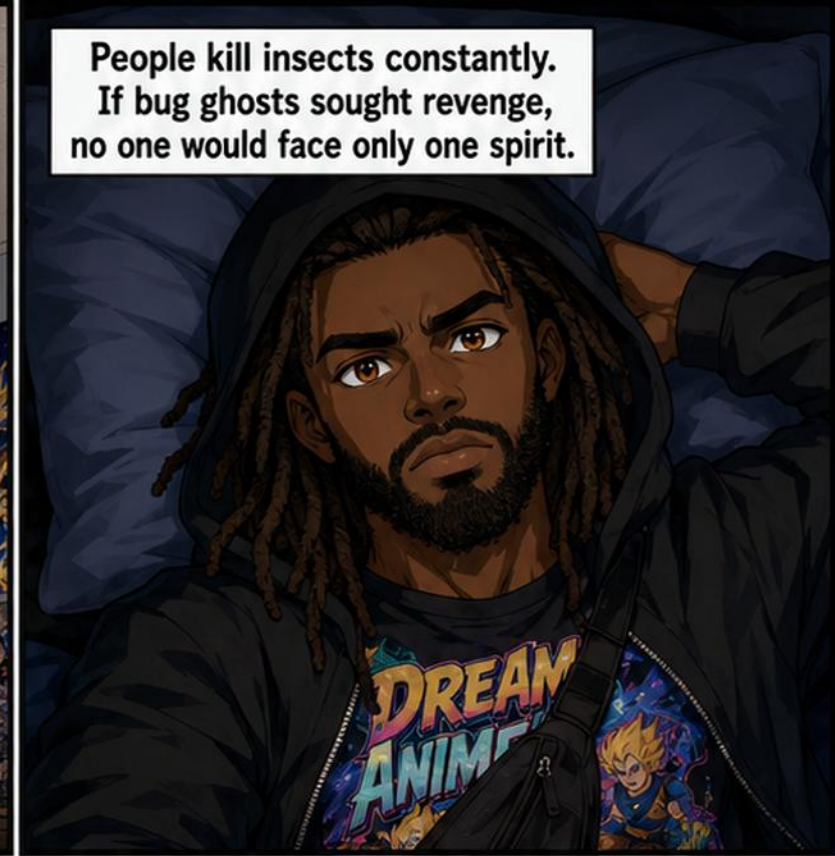


AUGUST 2, 2026

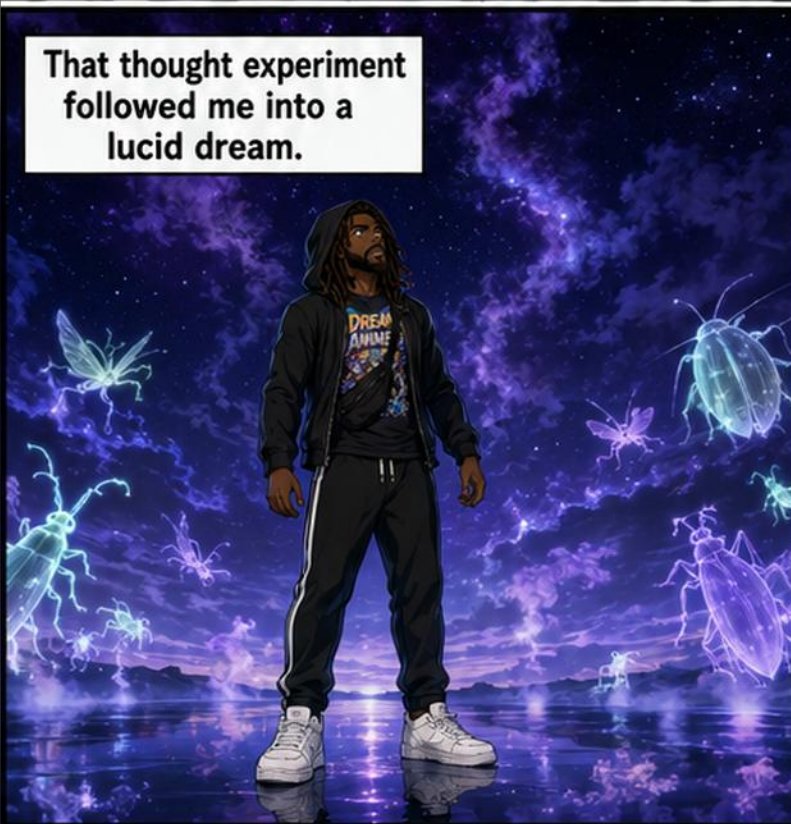
Before sleep, I killed a roach crawling across my ceiling—but the thought stayed with me.



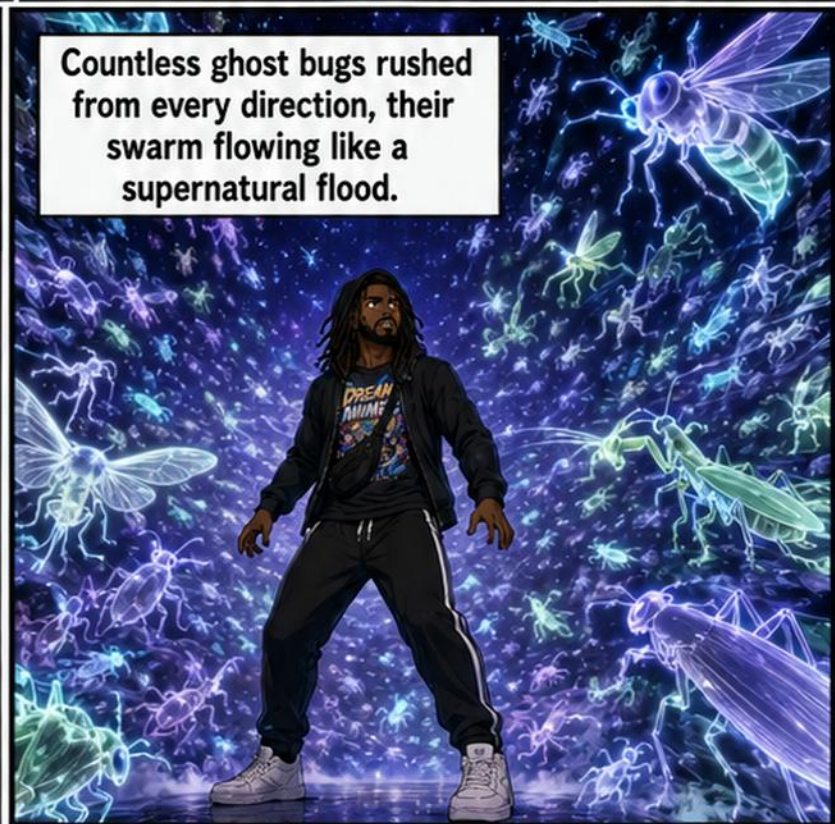
People kill insects constantly. If bug ghosts sought revenge, no one would face only one spirit.



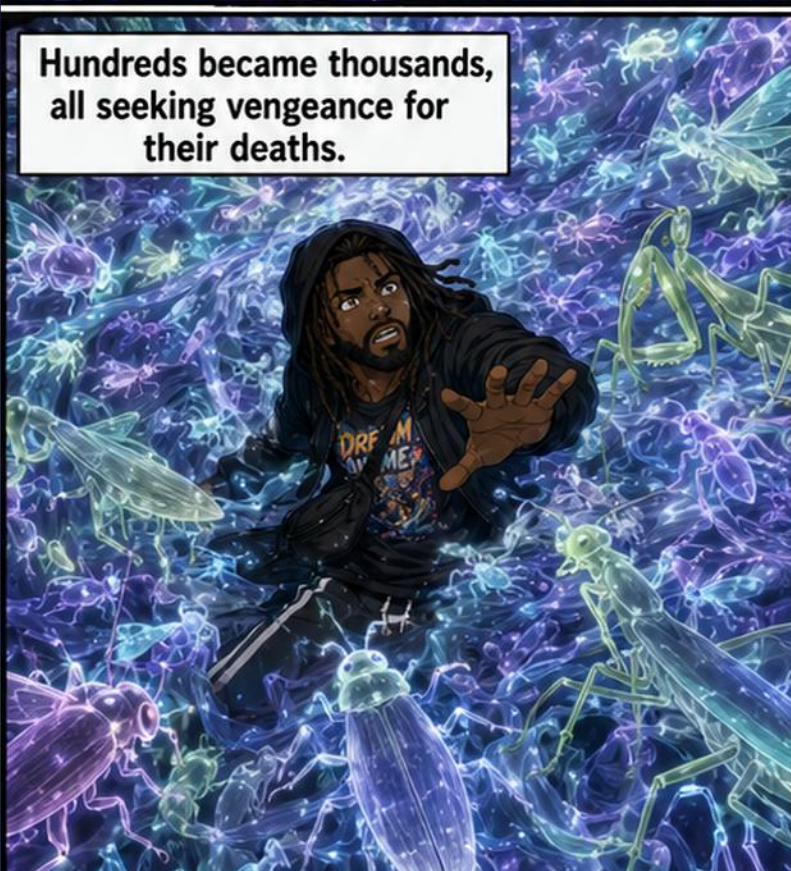
That thought experiment followed me into a lucid dream.



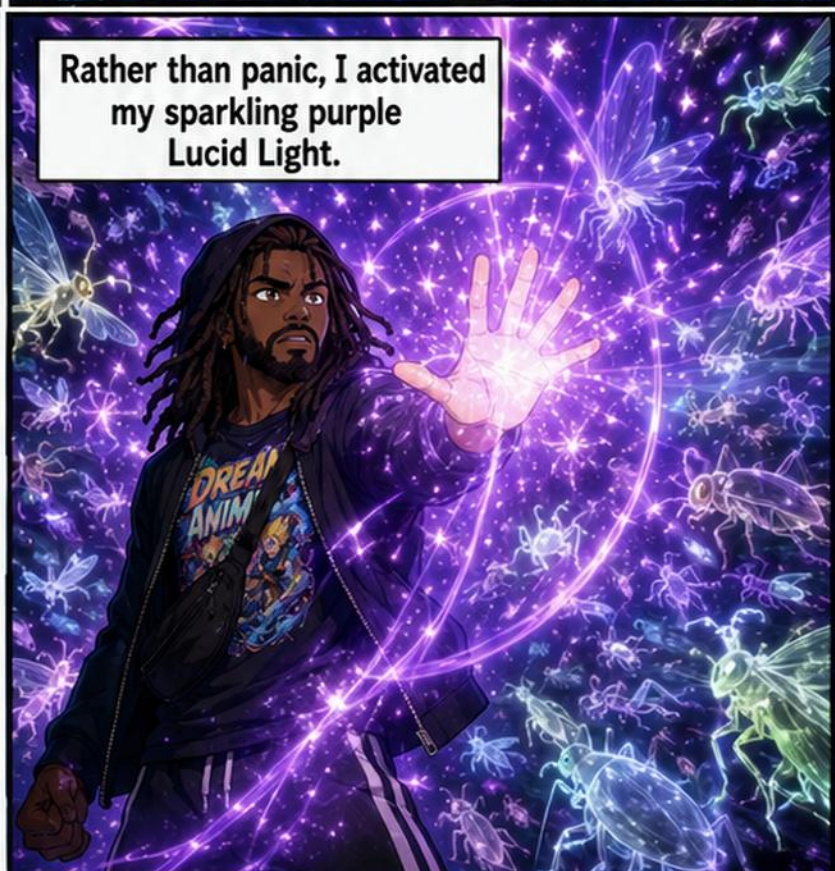
Countless ghost bugs rushed from every direction, their swarm flowing like a supernatural flood.



Hundreds became thousands, all seeking vengeance for their deaths.



Rather than panic, I activated my sparkling purple Lucid Light.



Fighting every spirit separately would have been nearly impossible, so I reshaped the swarm into one target.



Lucid Light pulled the ghost bugs together and compressed them into a humanoid body.



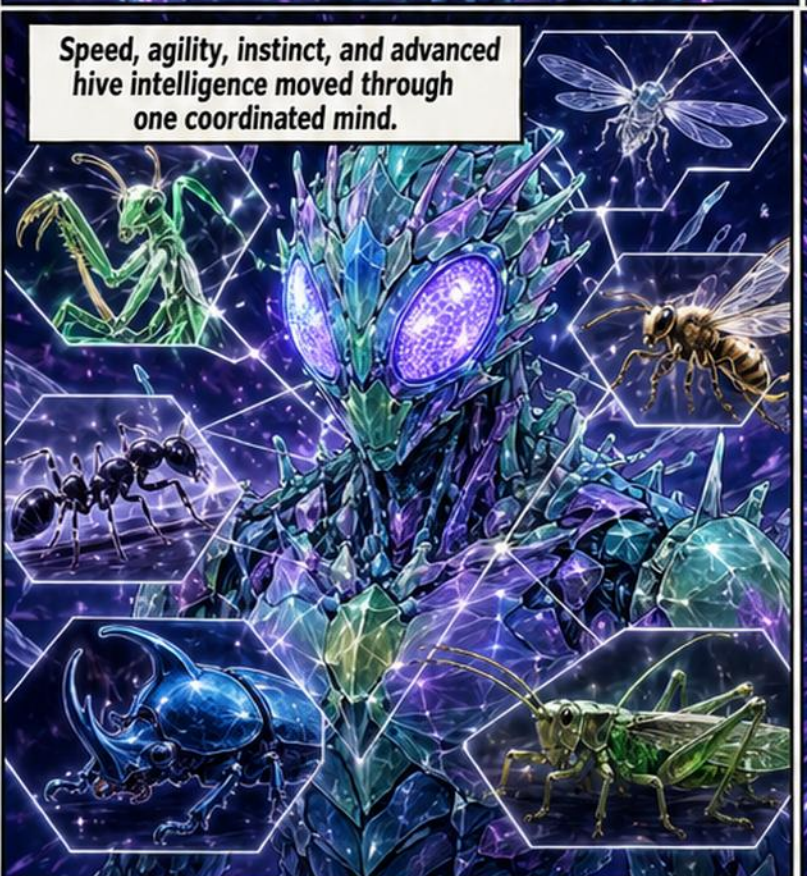
It stood only six or seven feet tall, but countless insect abilities had been concentrated inside it.



Its exoskeleton was resilient, and its strength reflected species able to lift many times their own weight.



Speed, agility, instinct, and advanced hive intelligence moved through one coordinated mind.



Before I could reconsider my plan, the ghost-bug humanoid charged.



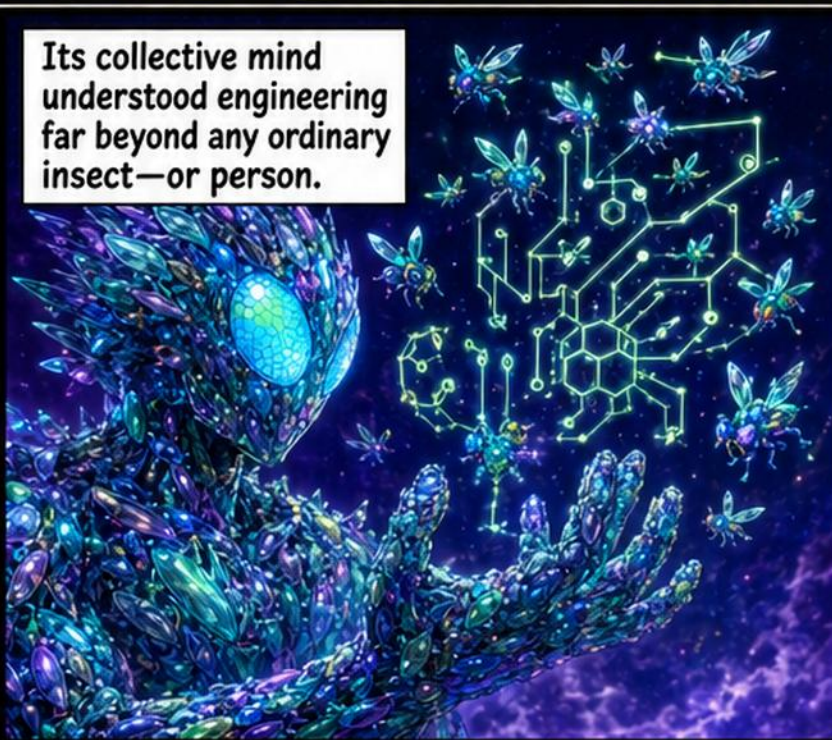
Its impossible speed carried it across the dreamspace before I could react.



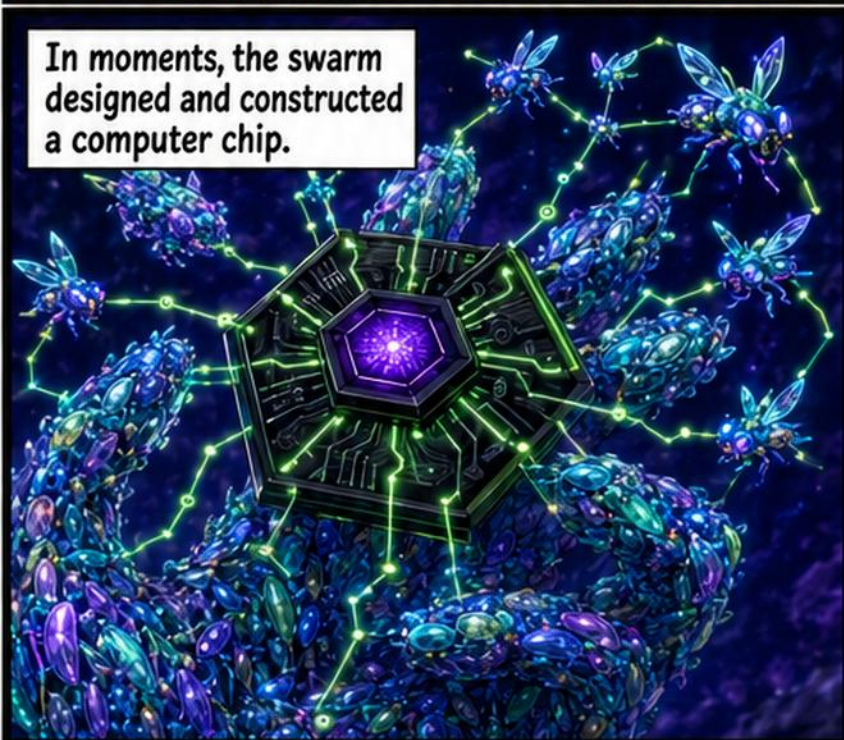
The creature grabbed me by the neck and lifted me into the air.



Its collective mind understood engineering far beyond any ordinary insect—or person.



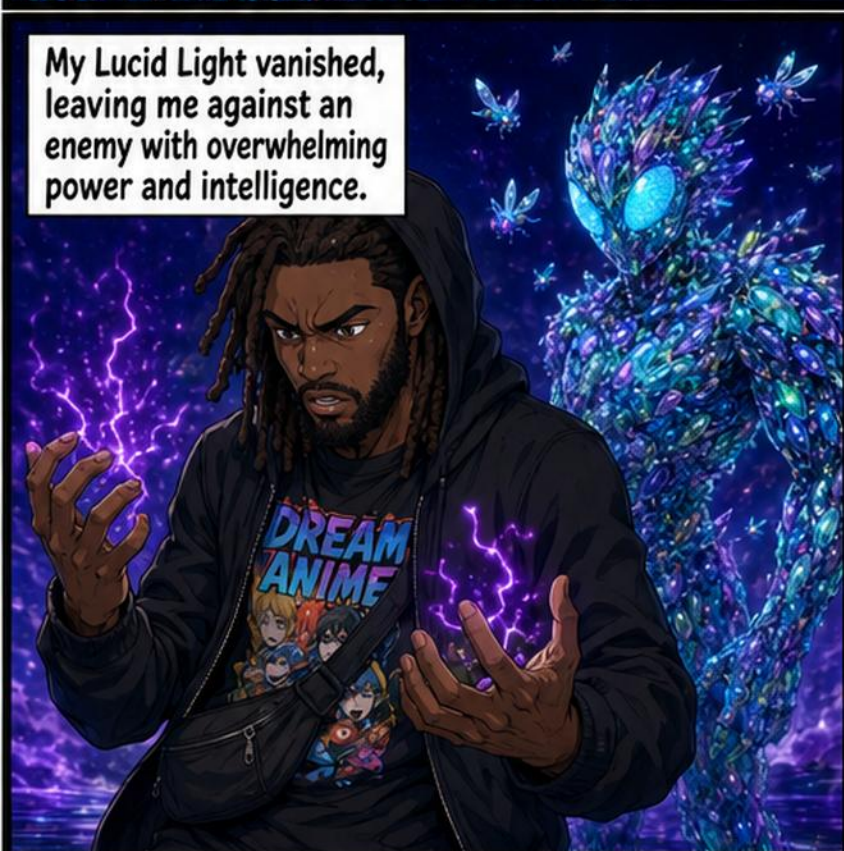
In moments, the swarm designed and constructed a computer chip.



It implanted the device into the back of my neck as an inhibitor.



My Lucid Light vanished, leaving me against an enemy with overwhelming power and intelligence.



Because I had gone to sleep late, I repeatedly woke feeling that I still needed more rest.

Each time I returned to sleep, the ghost-bug humanoid was waiting for me.

Again and again, it reached me and implanted the inhibitor.

I tried different approaches, but every path returned to the same powerless moment.

Then I realized the chip had disabled one power—not everything I carried.

Even without Lucid Light, I could still call upon Psilones, my living rainbow crystal Sword of Life.



Summoning Psilones was like reaching into a utility belt for equipment I already possessed.



The rainbow crystal Sword of Life appeared on my back.



Because Psilones had a life and will of its own, I did not need to draw or wield it.



At my call, the living sword turned and stabbed the inhibitor instead of attacking the swarm.



Its life-giving power awakened the chip, which pulled free, grew tiny legs, and crawled away.



The inhibition vanished, and my Lucid Light returned.



With my power restored,
I realized I did not actually
need to use it.



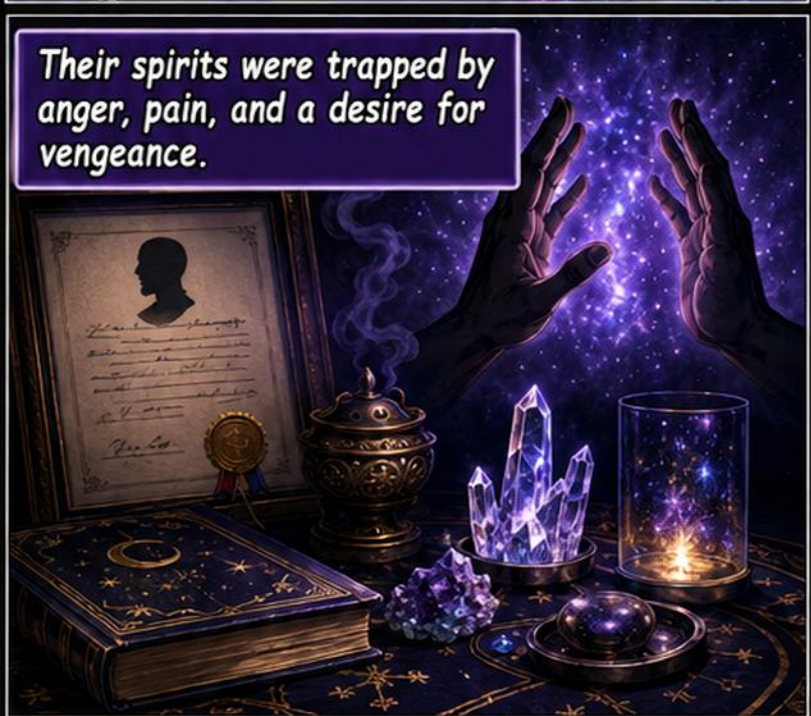
More importantly, fighting
had been the wrong approach
from the beginning.



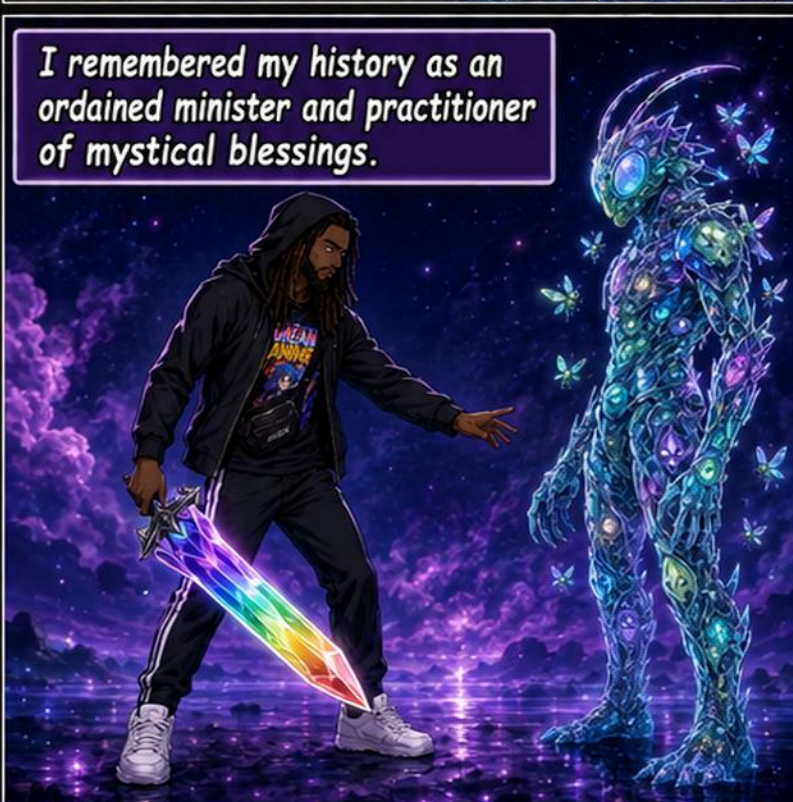
The bugs believed I had wronged
them, and in a sense, they were
right: I had killed them.



Their spirits were trapped by
anger, pain, and a desire for
vengeance.



I remembered my history as an
ordained minister and practitioner
of mystical blessings.



They did not need to be
punished. They needed to
be released.



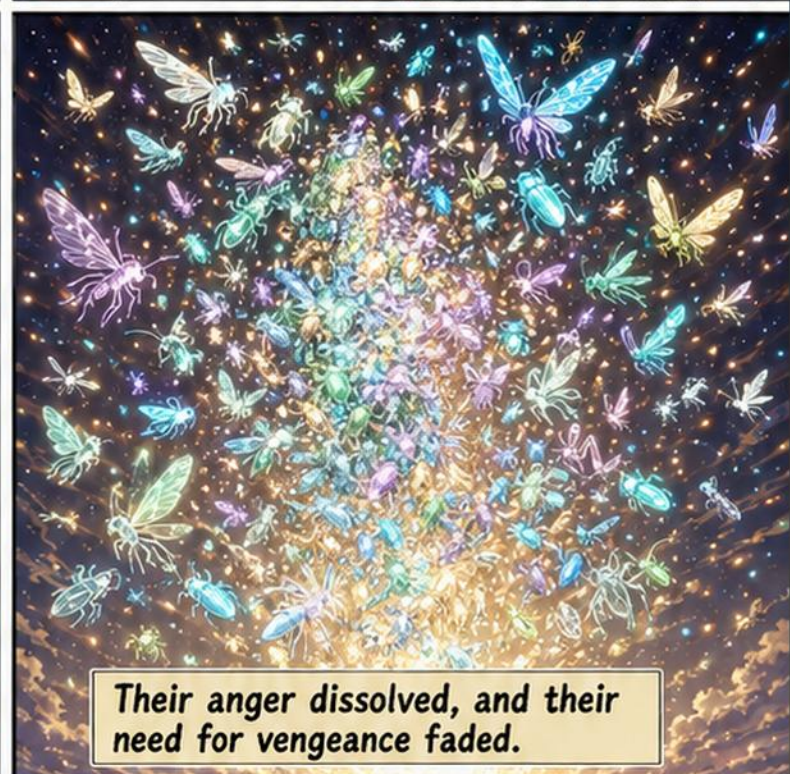
Drawing upon that spiritual part of my history, I chose not to attack the ghost-bug humanoid.



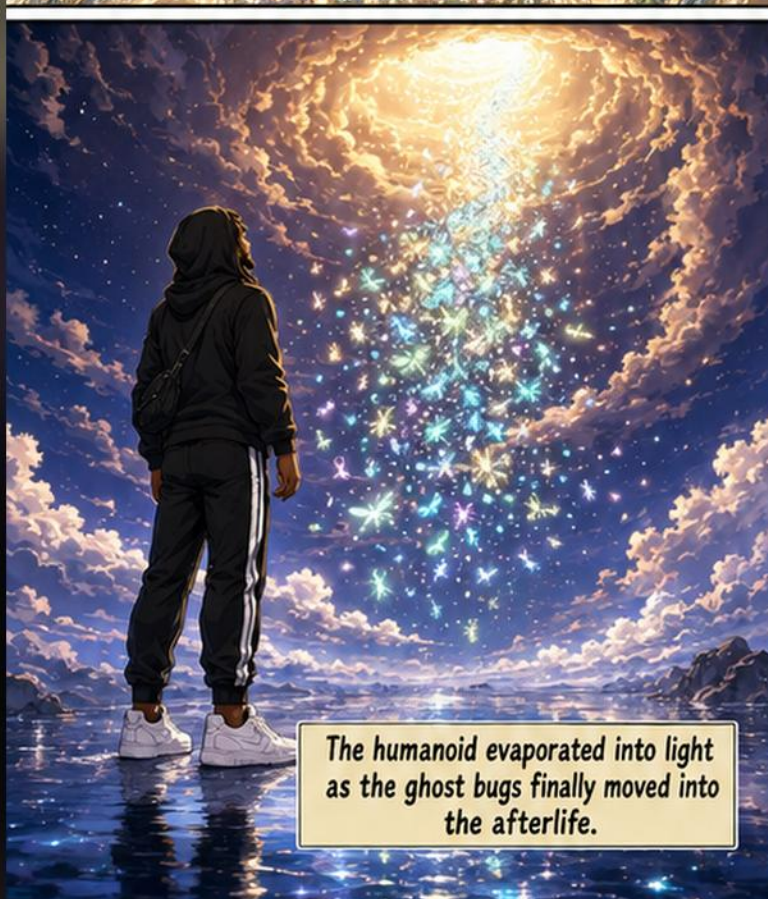
I blessed it.



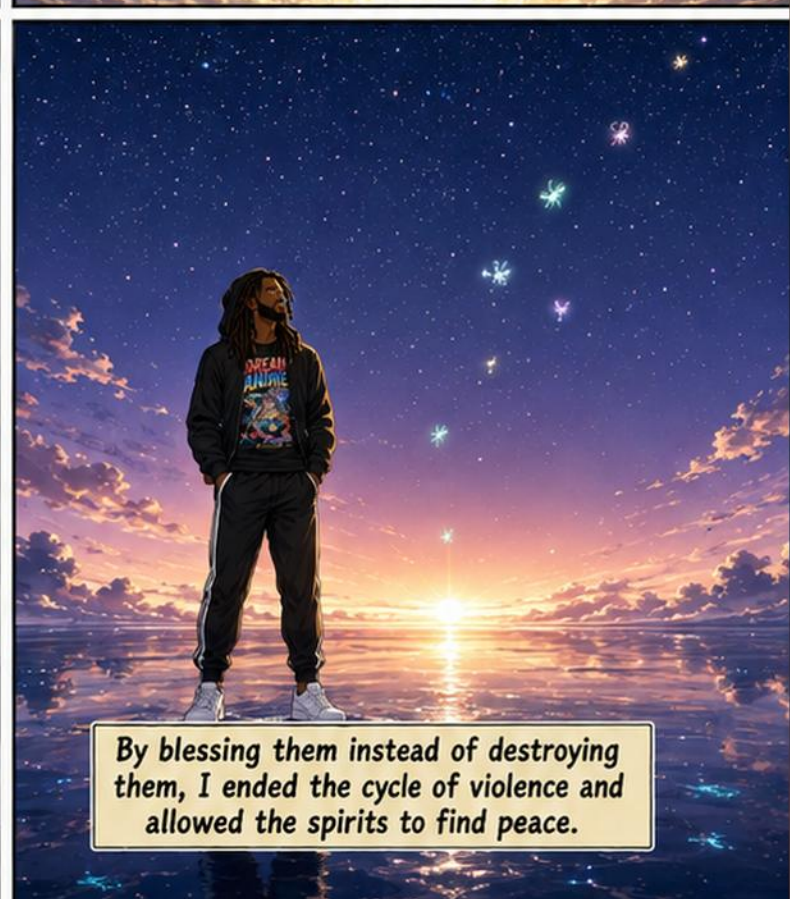
The blessing passed through the collective form and reached every insect spirit inside.



Their anger dissolved, and their need for vengeance faded.



The humanoid evaporated into light as the ghost bugs finally moved into the afterlife.



By blessing them instead of destroying them, I ended the cycle of violence and allowed the spirits to find peace.